

Community Learning Hubs — Grant Application

Submitted by BrightPath Community Initiative | Requested Funding: \$72,500

1. Organization Information

Legal Name of Organization:	BrightPath Community Initiative	Tax Exemption Status:	Registered Nonprofit (501(c)(3) equivalent)
Primary Contact Person:	Elena Rostova, Executive Director	Telephone:	(555) 014-8821
Physical Address:	742 Evergreen Way, Suite 200, Riverdale	Official Email:	e.rostova@brightpathcommunity.org
Website / Portal:	www.brightpathcommunity.org	Requested Grant Amount:	\$72,500.00

2. Organizational Background & Operating History

BrightPath Community Initiative is a grassroots nonprofit organization committed to expanding educational equity, digital literacy, and academic support systems for underserved children and families.

We have worked with communities across the region for several years and have been actively involved in education and youth development. Our team brings deep community ties, dedicated volunteer networks, and extensive frontline experience in designing after-school enrichment programs, family learning workshops, and youth mentorship forums.

Throughout our operational existence, BrightPath has focused on creating barrier-free, safe community spaces where young learners can overcome structural disadvantages and build foundational academic resilience.

3. Statement of Community Need

The Riverdale and Eastside neighborhoods face acute gaps in accessible out-of-school academic support and digital resources. According to recent regional municipal assessments, over 58% of public elementary and middle school students in these neighborhoods read below grade level, and more than 40% lack reliable broadband Internet access and desktop computer facilities at home.

Working families and single-parent households frequently lack affordable afternoon childcare or academic tutoring alternatives. Local public libraries experience extreme capacity constraints, resulting in long waiting queues for after-school computer terminals. Without dedicated community-based intervention, educational achievement disparities will continue to compound.

4. Project Description: Community Learning Hubs

The proposed 'Community Learning Hubs' initiative establishes two dedicated, after-school learning environments located directly within accessible neighborhood venues: the Riverdale Community Center / Riverdale Community School campus and the Eastside Youth Pavilion. These hubs will operate 4 days per week (Monday through Thursday, 3:30 PM to 6:30 PM) during the academic school year, providing a safe, structured, and stimulating educational environment.

Each hub will feature high-speed internet connectivity, dedicated laptop workstations, curated STEM and literacy materials, and structured homework coaching led by trained facilitators and community volunteers. In addition to academic tutoring, the hubs will host bi-weekly interactive STEM workshops, digital literacy labs, and weekend family literacy sessions.

5. Project Objectives

The Community Learning Hubs project is designed around three measurable core objectives to be accomplished during the 12-month grant term (January 1, 2027 – December 31, 2027):

- **Objective 1 (Access & Infrastructure):** Fully furnish, equip, and launch two Community Learning Hubs with 20 internet-connected laptop workstations, digital learning software, and foundational library resources by March 15, 2027.
- **Objective 2 (Student Enrollment & Retention):** Enroll and sustain active participation of at least 350 unduplicated K-8 students from low-income households across the two hub locations, delivering a minimum of 480 cumulative hours of guided tutoring and enrichment.
- **Objective 3 (Academic & Digital Literacy Gains):** Ensure that 75% of regularly attending students demonstrate measurable academic improvement in reading comprehension or foundational mathematics by the conclusion of the academic school year.

6. Target Population and Community Served

The Community Learning Hubs project specifically targets low-income and historically underserved youth aged 6–14 (Kindergarten through 8th Grade) and their families residing within the Riverdale and Eastside municipal districts.

Demographic Profile: Over 72% of families in the primary service area qualify for the Federal Free and Reduced-Price Lunch (FRPL) program. Approximately 35% of target students are English Language Learners (ELL), with Spanish and Arabic being the predominant primary household languages. Approximately 60% of participating students come from single-parent households.

Direct Geographic Scope: The initiative will serve residents within postal ZIP codes 04812, 04814, and 04815, focusing heavily on children attending Title I neighborhood elementary and middle schools.

7. Key Project Activities and Work Plan

BrightPath Community Initiative will execute four integrated activity streams across the grant lifecycle:

Activity Stream	Operational Description & Frequency	Target Output
Stream 1: After-School Homework & Tutoring	Daily small-group homework assistance, reading coaching, and foundational math tutoring provided 4 afternoons per week (12 hours/week) across both hubs.	350 students enrolled; 480 program hours delivered.
Stream 2: STEM & Digital Literacy Labs	Hands-on coding, basic robotics, and creative digital media workshops conducted twice weekly using project laptop stations and guided software modules.	24 unique workshop modules; 200 participants completed.
Stream 3: Family Engagement Nights	Monthly evening workshops for parents and guardians covering digital safety, navigating school district portals, and home reading encouragement strategies.	10 monthly family events; 150 parents attended.
Stream 4: Mentor Training & Supervision	Recruitment, comprehensive background checks, onboarding, and ongoing pedagogical coaching for 20 community volunteer tutors and 4 lead facilitators.	20 volunteer mentors active; 4 facilitators trained.

8. Project Implementation Timeline

The project will be executed over four structured operational quarters between January 1, 2027 and December 31, 2027:

Quarter / Phase	Key Milestones & Deliverables	Responsible Lead
Quarter 1 (Jan – Mar 2027): Setup & Launch	Finalize venue agreements; procure 20 laptops, furniture, and educational supplies; recruit and train 4 facilitators and 20 volunteers; launch student enrollment campaigns; Hub Grand Opening by March 15.	Program Coordinator & Lead Facilitators
Quarter 2 (Apr – Jun 2027): Spring Operations	Deliver core after-school tutoring (12 hrs/wk); launch bi-weekly STEM workshops; conduct initial student baseline assessments; host 3 monthly parent workshops.	Lead Facilitators & Volunteer Tutors
Quarter 3 (Jul – Sep 2027): Summer Bridge & Prep	Operate 6-week condensed summer literacy & STEM bridge camp (morning sessions); mid-year program review; refresh educational equipment; conduct fall tutor recruitment.	Program Coordinator & Site Staff
Quarter 4 (Oct – Dec 2027): Fall Hub & Evaluation	Resume full fall semester schedule; complete student post-program assessments; conduct community showcase event; compile comprehensive annual grant reporting.	Executive Director & Lead Staff

9. Project Evaluation and Measurement

We will monitor participation and collect feedback from students and community members. Program staff will keep daily sign-in sheets to track student attendance and ensure hub safety protocols are observed. During the school year, we will engage with teachers and parents to discuss how children are progressing in their regular classes.

Additionally, we plan to solicit feedback through informal questionnaires and verbal discussions at the conclusion of workshop series. This continuous feedback will allow our facilitators to adapt lesson pacing and adjust curriculum topics to better align with student interests and immediate school homework requirements. A summary of attendance and community responses will be assembled at the conclusion of the grant term.

10. Previous Organizational Experience and Track Record

BrightPath Community Initiative has established a recognized reputation for delivering high-impact neighborhood education initiatives. **Our previous community learning programs have reached more than 10,000 students across the region.**

Through our community partnerships, summer literacy pop-ups, and weekend reading camps, we have built trusted relationships with neighborhood families, local educators, and community volunteers. Our grassroots approach ensures that every educational intervention is culturally responsive and directly grounded in the lived realities of the youth we serve.

11. Sustainability Plan

We intend to continue the program after the grant period by developing local partnerships and seeking additional funding. Our board and development team are actively exploring relationships with regional businesses and municipal grants to maintain the hub infrastructure beyond 2027.

12. Project Budget Summary

BrightPath Community Initiative is formally requesting grant funding of **\$72,500.00** from Northstar Community Foundation. In accordance with grant guidelines, a comprehensive line-item expenditure schedule is provided separately in the official Project Budget document (project-budget.pdf) accompanying this narrative.

13. Submission Document Inventory & Status

The following inventory summarizes the submission materials assembled by BrightPath Community Initiative:

Document Title	Status in Application Package	Notes & Cross-References
Community Impact Grant Narrative	ATTACHED (This Document)	Complete narrative addressing program guidelines and operational plans.
Official Nonprofit Registration Certificate	SUBMITTED SEPARATELY	Official certificate issued by State Registrar (registration-certificate.pdf).
Detailed Project Line-Item Budget	SUBMITTED SEPARATELY	Itemized budget breakdown totaling \$72,500 (project-budget.pdf).
Previous Project Evaluation Report	SUBMITTED SEPARATELY	Summary report of 2025 pilot program outcomes (previous-project-report.pdf).
Institutional Partnership Letter	SUBMITTED SEPARATELY	Collaboration letter from Riverdale Community School (community-partnership-letter.pdf).
Letters of Community Support (Grassroots)	NOT INCLUDED	Community resident endorsement letters not finalized for this submission round.

14. Formal Declaration & Applicant Authorization

I hereby certify that all statements made in this grant application and all accompanying supporting documentation are true, accurate, and complete to the best of my knowledge. I understand that any false, misleading, or unsubstantiated representations may result in immediate disqualification or termination of any grant awarded.

Authorized Executive Signature: <i>Elena Rostova</i> Elena Rostova, Executive Director BrightPath Community Initiative Date: September 24, 2026	Authorized Board Chair Signature: <i>Marcus Vance</i> Marcus Vance, Board President BrightPath Community Initiative Date: September 24, 2026
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